Aurora Instruments

Company & Product Knowledge Base — Public Reference Edition v3.2 (2026)

Note: Aurora Instruments is a fictional company created for demonstration and testing purposes. All names, figures, and products below are invented and do not describe any real organization.

1. Company Overview

Aurora Instruments is a consumer environmental-sensing company that designs and manufactures connected home weather stations. The company was founded in 2019 in Boulder, Colorado, by Dr. Elena Varga and Marcus Reed, who previously worked together on atmospheric research instrumentation. As of early 2026, Aurora Instruments employs 112 people.

The company is headquartered in Boulder, Colorado, and operates a second office in Lisbon, Portugal, which opened in 2023 to support European sales and customer service. All hardware is assembled at a contract facility in Fremont, California.

Mission

Aurora's stated mission is to make professional-grade atmospheric data accessible to households, educators, and local communities. The company publishes an open community map, called AuroraLive, where owners may optionally share their station readings publicly.

Product Family at a Glance

Aurora sells a single product line, the SkyNode home weather station, in three models: SkyNode Lite, SkyNode Pro, and SkyNode Max. All three models connect to the Aurora mobile app (iOS and Android) and to the AuroraLive web dashboard. Detailed specifications appear on page 2.

Fact	Value
Founded	2019
Headquarters	Boulder, Colorado, USA
Second office	Lisbon, Portugal (opened 2023)
Assembly facility	Fremont, California, USA
Employees (2026)	112
Founders	Dr. Elena Varga and Marcus Reed
Product line	SkyNode home weather station

2. SkyNode Product Specifications

Every SkyNode station ships with a central hub and a set of outdoor sensor modules. The number of sensors, the wireless range, and the battery life differ by model, as shown below. All models operate across a temperature range of -40°C to 60°C.

Specification	SkyNode Lite	SkyNode Pro	SkyNode Max
Price (USD)	$149	$299	$499
Number of sensors	5	9	14
Wireless range	60 m	120 m	300 m
Battery life	12 months	18 months	24 months
Data update interval	60 seconds	10 seconds	10 seconds
Connectivity	Wi-Fi (2.4 GHz)	Wi-Fi (2.4/5 GHz)	Wi-Fi + cellular backup
Onboard storage	7 days	30 days	90 days

Sensors by Model

The SkyNode Lite measures temperature, humidity, barometric pressure, wind speed, and rainfall. The SkyNode Pro adds wind direction, UV index, air quality (PM2.5), and lightning detection. The SkyNode Max includes everything in the Pro plus soil moisture, soil temperature, leaf wetness, snow depth, and a secondary backup temperature sensor.

Measurement Accuracy

Temperature readings are accurate to within ±0.3°C. Relative humidity is accurate to within ±2%. Barometric pressure is accurate to within ±0.5 hPa. The rain gauge resolves precipitation in increments of 0.2 mm.

Power

Each outdoor sensor module is powered by two AA lithium batteries. The central hub is powered by the included USB-C adapter and contains a backup battery that keeps the station running for up to 8 hours during a power outage.

3. AuroraLive Cloud Plans

A SkyNode station works without any subscription, but the optional AuroraLive cloud service adds longer data history, alerts, and data export. There are three plans: Basic, Plus, and Pro. The Basic plan is free and is included with every station.

Feature	Basic (Free)	Plus	Pro
Monthly price	$0	$4.99	$12.99
Annual price	$0	$49	$129
Data history	7 days	1 year	Unlimited
Stations per account	1	3	10
Custom alerts	No	Yes	Yes
CSV / data export	No	No	Yes
Public API access	No	No	Yes
Support response time	48 hours	24 hours	4 hours

Billing Details

Paying annually saves roughly 18% compared with paying monthly. All paid plans include a 14-day free trial, and subscriptions can be cancelled at any time from the account settings page. If a subscription is cancelled, the account reverts to the Basic plan at the end of the current billing period, and data history older than 7 days becomes inaccessible but is not deleted for 90 days.

Education Discount

Verified schools and non-profit organizations receive a 40% discount on the Plus and Pro plans and on hardware purchases of five or more stations. To apply, contact the sales team with proof of eligibility; approval usually takes 3 business days.

4. Warranty, Returns & Support

Warranty

Every SkyNode station comes with a standard 2-year limited warranty covering manufacturing defects. If the product is registered in the Aurora app within 30 days of purchase, the warranty is extended to 3 years at no additional cost. The warranty does not cover damage from misuse, unauthorized modification, or lightning strikes to the hub itself.

Returns

Hardware purchased directly from Aurora may be returned within 45 days of delivery for a full refund, provided it is in resalable condition. Return shipping is free within the United States and the European Union. Refunds are processed within 10 business days of the returned item being received.

Repairs

Out-of-warranty repairs are available for a flat fee of $59 plus parts. The typical repair turnaround is 10 business days from the date Aurora receives the device. Loaner units are offered to Pro-plan subscribers while their device is being repaired.

Support Channels

Customer support is available by email at support@aurorainstruments.example and by live chat in the Aurora app. Phone support is reserved for Pro-plan subscribers. Support operates Monday through Friday, 8:00 a.m. to 6:00 p.m. Mountain Time, excluding U.S. public holidays. First-response targets are listed in the cloud plan table on page 3.

Policy	Value
Standard warranty	2 years
Extended warranty (if registered in 30 days)	3 years
Return window	45 days
Refund processing time	10 business days
Out-of-warranty repair fee	$59 + parts
Repair turnaround	10 business days
Support hours	Mon-Fri, 8am-6pm Mountain Time

5. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How do I reset a SkyNode station to factory settings?

A: Press and hold the button on the central hub for 10 seconds until the status light flashes red. The hub will restart and return to setup mode. Reconfiguration through the app takes about 5 minutes.

Q: How are firmware updates delivered?

A: Firmware updates are downloaded and installed automatically. Aurora releases updates roughly once a month, and installation happens overnight so it does not interrupt data collection.

Q: My sensor is not reporting data. What should I check first?

A: First confirm the sensor is within the model's wireless range of the hub. Next, check the battery level in the app. If both are fine, remove and reinsert the batteries to force the sensor to re-pair with the hub.

Q: Can I view my data if my internet goes down?

A: Yes. The hub stores recent readings locally (7 days on Lite, 30 days on Pro, and 90 days on Max), and the app can read directly from the hub over your local network even when the internet is unavailable.

Q: What batteries do the sensor modules use?

A: Each outdoor sensor module uses two AA lithium batteries. Lithium cells are recommended over alkaline because they perform far better in freezing conditions.

Q: How accurate is the temperature reading?

A: Temperature is accurate to within plus or minus 0.3 degrees Celsius. For best accuracy, mount the sensor in a shaded, well-ventilated spot at least 1.5 meters above the ground.

Q: Can I share my station's data publicly?

A: Yes. In the app you can opt in to AuroraLive, the public community map. Sharing is off by default, and you can revoke it at any time.

Q: Does the station work outside Wi-Fi coverage?

A: The SkyNode Max includes cellular backup and can operate without Wi-Fi. The Lite and Pro models require a 2.4 GHz Wi-Fi connection to sync to the cloud, though they continue to log data locally.

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